

A FREE REPORT FOR FLORIDA ROOFERS



Read this before you pay for
another lead!



What your marketing company won't dare tell a Florida roofer.

Eight truths about leads, retainers, and the 15-year roof rule.
From a Lakeland marketing team that would rather tell you than
sell you.

Nothing in this report is a secret.

Hey, it's Grant Sparks. I run Spark Sites here in Lakeland. We've been building websites since 2004 and marketing local businesses out of Lakeland since 2013.

I wrote this because I keep having the same conversation with roofers.

Good crew. Great work. Five-star reviews from the people who found them. And a marketing bill that makes no sense: leads rented from a lead service, a monthly agency report nobody can read, and a phone that only really rings after a storm.

Everything in here is stuff the people selling you leads and retainers have no reason to say out loud. So I'll say it.

15

minutes to read, start to finish

8

truths, each ending with one thing to do this week

10

questions to ask before you sign with anyone

Grant Sparks

Spark Sites, Lakeland, Florida

\$228

is what one paid search lead costs a home-service business, on average. A shared lead can be sold to as many as 16 contractors.

1. You're not buying leads. You're renting them.

Lead services sell the same homeowner request to several roofers at once. You pay whether you win the job or not, and you race the other roofers to the phone the second it lands.

- Once you count the jobs you lose, a closed job from a shared-lead service costs \$600 to \$1,200.
- The FTC ordered HomeAdvisor to pay up to **\$7.2 million** after finding it misrepresented the quality, characteristics, and source of its leads.

But the price isn't the real problem. The day you stop paying, the leads stop. You never owned any of it. You rented a phone number.

Owned leads come from three things you control: a Google Business Profile in the top three on the map, a steady stream of reviews, and a website that ranks for the towns you serve. They take a few months to build. Then your cost per lead drops toward zero, because nobody is charging you for the click.



DO THIS THIS WEEK

Add up what you paid lead services in the last 12 months. Divide it by the jobs you actually closed from those leads. That's your real cost per job. Measure every marketing decision against that number.

1.1 to 3.3

roof replacements of revenue, every year, just to cover a \$3,000 to \$5,000 a month agency retainer.

2. Their retainer was built for a bigger company than yours.

Traditional marketing agencies quote \$3,000 to \$5,000 a month. That's \$36,000 to \$60,000 a year.

A full roof replacement in Florida runs about \$18,000 to \$32,000. So the retainer alone eats somewhere between 1.1 and 3.3 roofs of revenue a year. Before shingles. Before the crew. Before dump fees and the net-30 supplier bill. Shingle prices alone are up about 41% since 2020.

The tactics agencies sell do work. Ads work. SEO works. Content works. What doesn't work is the budget. It was built for companies with a marketing department and six months of runway, not a one-to-four-crew roofing company making payroll while it waits on an adjuster's check.

That's the math nobody in my industry wants to talk about.



DO THIS THIS WEEK

Ask any marketing company one question: "How many roof jobs do I need to sell each month to pay you back?" If they can't answer in one sentence, they don't understand your business.

4

numbers tell you whether your marketing works: calls, requests, inspections booked, and jobs sold.

3. The monthly report is not results.

You know the report. A PDF full of impressions, click-through rates, and graphs that go up and to the right. It looks busy. It tells you almost nothing. A roofer needs four numbers:

01

Calls

02

Form and text requests

03

Inspections booked

04

Jobs sold

Here's an insider one. **Calls from your website are not tracked unless someone sets it up on purpose.** Google's standard analytics does not count a tap on your phone number out of the box. So a lot of roofing sites have no idea how many calls they generate, and a lot of agency reports count what's easy (clicks) instead of what's true (calls).



DO THIS THIS WEEK

Ask whoever runs your marketing for last month's calls, form requests, inspections booked, and jobs sold. If they can't give you the first two, everything else in the report is a guess.

3

businesses make Google's map pack: the short list a homeowner sees first when they search "roofer near me."

4. Three names on a map beat your whole ad budget.

That list sits above everything else, and it's where the calls come from, especially the week after a storm. You get into it the boring way, done all the way:

- A **Google Business Profile** filled out completely and kept active.
- **Reviews** coming in every month, with replies.
- A **website** whose name, address, and phone match the profile, with one page per service and your towns in the page titles.

That's also the right order: profile, reviews, a website that converts, and only then ads. Most roofers start with ads and decide marketing doesn't work.

Proof from a trade that runs on the same mechanics: when we did exactly this for Superior Spray, a Central Florida pest control company, search traffic climbed **276% in the first 90 days**, and they hit their annual target in seven months.



DO THIS THIS WEEK

Fill out your Google Business Profile completely: real hours, every service listed separately, your towns as the service area, and ten photos of real roofs your crew finished. Then text three happy customers for a review today.

84%

of people hang up on calls from numbers they don't recognize. After a storm, the lead goes to whoever answers first.

5. The storm lead goes to whoever answers first.

After a storm, a homeowner doesn't call one roofer. They fill out three forms and wait to see who gets back to them.

People who prefer texting a business over a call or email **72%**

Average reply time to a text **about 90 seconds**

Average reply time to an email **about 90 minutes**

If your website form drops into an inbox you check at 9pm, you lost that lead at 6:15.

The fix: every form and every missed call gets a text back within about a minute, day or night, with a simple way to book the inspection. Then when you call, it's from a number they've already seen.



DO THIS THIS WEEK

Fill out your own website form tonight, from your phone, like a homeowner would. Time how long it takes for anyone to respond. That's what every one of your leads experiences.

15

years: the roof age where Florida insurers start asking questions. Under SB 808, a roofer can now do the inspection that answers them.

6. The 15-year roof rule is the biggest marketing opening in Florida roofing.

Under SB 808, which took effect July 1, 2026, an insurer can't refuse or non-renew a policy just because the roof is older than 15 years if a licensed inspector certifies at least five years of life left. And the law now lets roofing contractors perform that inspection themselves.

Every Florida homeowner with an aging roof and a letter from their carrier is looking for a roofer who understands the paperwork. Most marketing companies haven't built a single page about it. What to build:

- A page that answers "roof inspection for insurance," with a button to book one.
- Insurance inspections listed as their own service on your Google Business Profile.
- Reviews that mention you helped with the insurance side.

This is marketing, not legal advice. Confirm the specifics with FRSA or your attorney before you promise a homeowner anything.



DO THIS THIS WEEK

Add "insurance roof inspection" as a service on your Google Business Profile, and write one post explaining the 15-year rule in plain English, with your phone number at the end.

210

Facebook posts from 10 Polk County roofers, scanned. The one that performed best wasn't a roof.

7. Storm chasers are beating you online, not on the roof.

Every big storm brings out-of-state crews who show up before local companies can mobilize, sign fast insurance jobs, and leave before the warranty calls start.

Being local only wins if the homeowner can see it. In the three seconds they spend on your website or Google profile, a local roofer and a storm chaser look exactly the same.

So show them. Your license number. "Locally owned since" and your year. Your towns by name. Real photos of your actual crew. Reviews from their neighbors.

In our scan, the best-performing post was a free back-to-school community event: **60 likes, 30 shares**. Employee spotlights drew the most comments. Community and crew beat roof photos every time. Storm chasers can't fake that. BAM.



DO THIS THIS WEEK

Put your license number, how long you've been local, and a photo of your real crew at the top of your homepage and on your Google Business Profile.

100%

of your domain, website, Google Business Profile, ad accounts, and reviews should be in your name. Not your marketing company's.

8. You should own everything, and they should teach you.

Some marketing companies keep your website, your domain, your Google profile, and your ad accounts under their own logins. Leave, and you start from zero. That's not a partnership. That's a hostage situation with a monthly invoice.

Everything should be in your name. Your marketing company gets added as a manager, not an owner.

And here's the bigger one. Our industry builds dependence and confusion on purpose. It's how agencies keep clients on retainer for years without the client ever understanding what they're paying for.

Break that. Hire people who explain what they did, why they did it, and what happened, in plain English, every month.



DO THIS THIS WEEK

Check who's listed as the owner of your domain, your Google Business Profile, and your ad accounts. If it isn't you, fix it this month.



10 questions to ask any marketing company before you sign.

Bring this page to the meeting. If they fumble three or more, keep your checkbook closed.

- ☐ 01 How many roof jobs do I need to sell each month to pay you back?
- ☐ 02 Who owns my domain, website, Google Business Profile, and ad accounts?
- ☐ 03 Is there a contract? What does it cost me to leave?
- ☐ 04 What numbers will you report every month?
The right answer: calls, requests, inspections booked, jobs sold.
- ☐ 05 Are calls from my website tracked? How?
- ☐ 06 How fast does a new lead get a response at 9pm on a Saturday?
- ☐ 07 How will you get me into the top three on the map for my towns?
- ☐ 08 How will you get me new reviews every month without me asking by hand?
- ☐ 09 Are my leads ever shared with another roofer?
The right answer: never.
- ☐ 10 Will you teach me what you're doing, in plain English?

One program for roofers. It answers all ten questions the same way, every time.

\$297

a month, all in.

No contracts. 90-day money-back guarantee. We never hold your site hostage.

SPARK CARE FOR ROOFERS INCLUDES

- ✓ A custom roofing website: replacement, repair, and storm pages, plus a quote form that hits your phone.
- ✓ Review requests by text the day the job closes, and replies to every review.
- ✓ Blog and social content built from your finished jobs.
- ✓ Google Business Profile management and local SEO for your towns.
- ✓ AI follow-up that texts every new lead back in about a minute, day or night.
- ✓ A dedicated consultant who explains every number in plain English.

NOT SURE IT FITS? ASK FOR THE FREE AUDIT

We review your website, your Google Business Profile, and your reviews like you already hired us, then hand you the findings either way. No pitch required.

Call or text (863) 225-1713

sparkmysite.com/roofing-marketing

See you on the map, **Grant Sparks**

Adapted from Spark Demand, the upcoming book by Grant Sparks and Nicole Bradham.

Where the numbers come from.

- 01 Cost per lead for home services, roofing average \$228.15. [LocaliQ, 2025 Search Ad Benchmarks for Home Services](#)
- 02 Florida roof replacement cost, about \$18,000 to \$32,000 for a typical 1,700 to 2,000 square foot roof. [Modernize, Average Roof Replacement Cost Florida: 2026 Prices by Type and Material](#)
- 03 Shared Angi leads sold to up to 16 contractors; \$600 to \$1,200 per closed job. [LeadTruffle, The Complete Guide to Angi Leads for Home Service Contractors](#)
- 04 HomeAdvisor misrepresented lead quality; up to \$7.2 million in redress. [Federal Trade Commission order](#)
- 05 Shingle prices up about 41% since 2020. [AccuLynx, summarizing the ServiceTitan 2026 Roofing and Exterior Market Report](#)
- 06 84% hang up on calls from unknown numbers. [Mosaicx](#)
- 07 72% prefer texting a business. [Leadferno survey](#)
- 08 Text reply about 90 seconds, email about 90 minutes. [AccuLynx](#)
- 09 SB 808 and the 15-year roof rule. [Florida House bill detail](#) and [Extreme Roofing explainer](#)
- 10 Storm chasers arriving before local companies mobilize. [Roofing Contractor](#)
- 11 Facebook scan of 210 posts from 10 Polk County roofers, and the Superior Spray result: Spark Sites internal research and client data, September 2026.



Grant Sparks Lakeland, Florida

Ready when you are. Call or text (863) 225-1713, or visit sparkmysite.com/roofing-marketing.